

1787

RUSSO-TURKISH WAR RESTARTS

After previous wars between Russia and the Ottomans, the Russian empress Catherine annexed the Crimean peninsula. Fearing that her plan was to partition their empire with the Austrian Habsburg empire, the Ottomans went to war. The conflict ended in 1791 with the Ottomans ceding the entire western Ukrainian Black Sea coast to Russia.



△ The Imperial Russian Army besieging the Turkish port of Ochakov

1785 The invention of the power loom revolutionizes the textile industry

1785

1785 English social reformer Jeremy Bentham argues for the decriminalization of homosexuality

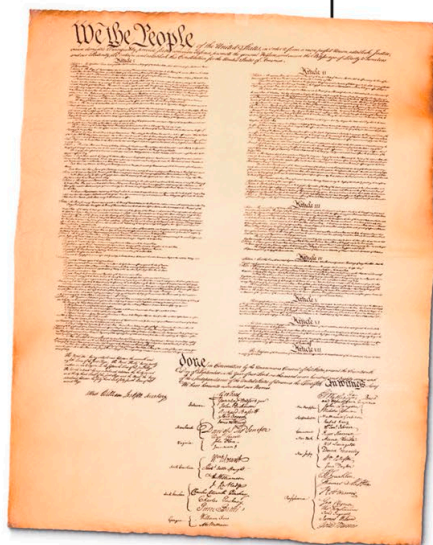
1786 The collapse of a dam on the Dadu River in China causes a flood that kills around 100,000 people

1787 Formerly enslaved people colonize Sierra Leone, arriving from England, Nova Scotia, and Jamaica



**1732-99
GEORGE WASHINGTON**

A signatory of the US Constitution, George Washington was the United States' first president (1789-97), serving two terms before retiring to his family estate at Mount Vernon, Virginia.



1787

US CONSTITUTION SIGNED

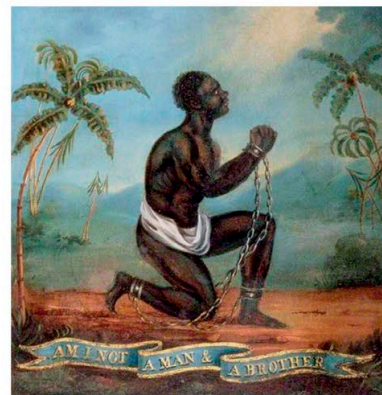
On 17 September 1787, 39 delegates of the Constitutional Convention met in the Assembly Room of the Pennsylvania State House to sign the US Constitution. Beginning "We the people", it laid out the rights of American citizens and defined the tripartite structure of the federal government: the legislative (Congress); the executive (the president and government officers); and the judicial (Supreme Court and other federal courts).

◁ The US Constitution parchment

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CALLS INCREASE FOR THE ABOLITION OF SLAVERY

As questions were raised – particularly by the Religious Society of Friends (Quakers) – about the moral justifications for slavery, several societies emerged in Europe calling for its abolition. These included the French Société des Amis des Noir and the British Society for the Abolition of the Slave Trade.



▽ A popular abolitionist image